

In the Census of Population and Housing - 2024, data collection was carried out primarily using the CAPI (Computer Assisted Personal Interviewing) method. As a result, the time and cost required for data entry were significantly reduced, enabling the publication of census data more rapidly compared with previous censuses.

Accordingly, the preliminary report containing basic census information (based on provisional data) titled "Population of Sri Lanka by District" was officially released on 24 March 2025. This report was presented to His Excellency the President, who serves as the Minister in charge of the line ministry, and it presented the total population of the country at the district level.

In the second stage, population and housing information at the Divisional Secretariat Division level was released on 30 October 2025. At the same time, selected population and housing statistics were also published as data tables and maps at the Grama Niladhari Division level, which is the smallest administrative unit in the country.

The final report and the Census dashboard of the Census of Population and Housing, which will include comprehensive and detailed information across a wide range of subject areas, is scheduled to be released on 20 March 2026.

Table 1.1.2 : The Questions and Topics Included in the Censuses of Sri Lanka 1871 - 2024

The question topics included in the census schedule	Census Year														
	1871	1881	1891	1901	1911	1921	1931*	1946	1953	1963	1971	1981	2001	2012	2024
Demographic and Personal Information															
Name	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Relationship to head of the household	X	X	X	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Sex	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Date of birth	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	X	X	X
Age	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	-	-	-
Marital Status	X	-	-	X	X	X	X	X	S	X	X	X	X	X	X
Ethnic group	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Religion	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Citizenship	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
N.I.C. No.	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X
Status of clergy/priest	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X
Educational Characteristics															
Ability to speak Sinhala & Tamil	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	-	-	-	-	-
Ability to speak English	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	X	X	X	-	-	-	-	-
Ability to speak Sinhala, English & Tamil	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X	X
Literacy	-	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	-	-	-	-
English Literacy	-	-	-	X	X	X	X	X		X	-	-	-	-	-
Sinhala, English & Tamil Literacy	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	X
Computer Literacy	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X
Digital Literacy	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X
Educational attainment/Highest level of Education	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	XS	X	X	X	X	X	X
School Attendance/ Attend in educational activity	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X	X	X	X
Vocational & Apprenticeship qualification	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	X	X